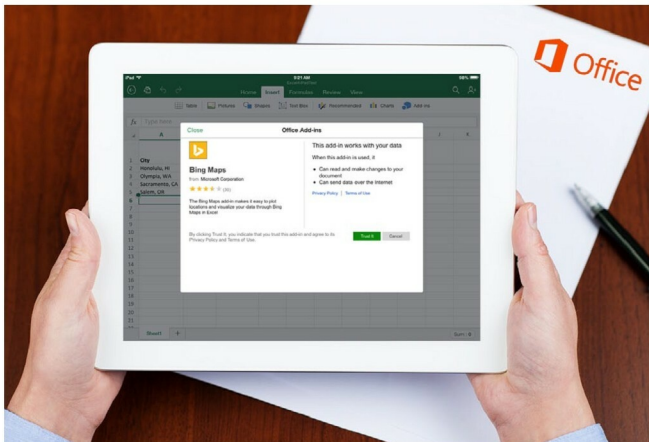


Get Started with Developing MS Office Add-ins



You can spruce up Microsoft Office, and add custom commands and new features to Office programs that help increase your productivity by using add-ins. Further, you can develop your own custom add-ins to give your documents style and class. In this tutorial, you can learn how to build a word cloud generator add-in for Microsoft Word.

Add-ins have been an important part of the Microsoft Office suite as they allow users and third-party developers to extend the capabilities and functionalities of Office, and with more than 1.2 billion users worldwide (https://news.microsoft.com/bythenumbers/ms_numbers.pdf), there is quite a large market for apps on this platform.

Previously, one had to use things like VBA, Com add-ins, VSTO, etc, to write add-ins for Office, but now all that you need is the Open Web Platform.

A high level overview of the platform

The Office Add-ins platform allows us to build apps using existing Web standards like HTML 5, CSS, JavaScript and RESTful Service that can interact with office documents,

mails, calendars, meeting requests and appointments.

Office currently has three types of add-ins that you can build:

- **Task pane add-in:** This appears at the side of the document and allows you to provide contextual and functional features in it.
- **Content add-ins:** These appear in the body of the document.
- **Outlook add-ins:** These appear next to an Outlook item when it's being viewed or edited. They require Exchange 2013 or Exchange Online to host the user's mailbox.

Anatomy of an Office add-in

An Office project consists of a *manifest.xml* file bundled with a Web application. The Manifest file can be submitted